

B2 First for Schools Speaking Part 2

Aims of the lesson	- to familiarise students with Part 2 of the Speaking test - to give the students an opportunity to practise the long turn
Time needed	1 hour
Materials required	- Student's worksheets 1 and 2 (enough copies of each worksheet for half of the class) - Student's worksheet 3 (one copy for each student) - Student's worksheets 4 and 5 (enough copies of each worksheet for half of the class)

Procedure

- Explain to the students that they are going to find out about Part 2 of the B2 First for Schools Speaking test and practise doing this part of the test. This part is called the long turn, because they have to speak for 1 minute on a given topic, so they need to get used to how it feels to talk on their own for a minute.
- As a warmer, play 'Just a Minute' with your class. Write the following topics on the board (you can add your own according to your students' interests):

Football	swimming	my favourite food
computer games	School	my music
- Arrange the students into pairs. Ask one student in each pair to pick a topic from the board, and get their partner to talk about it for 1 minute. Time them and give them a signal for when to start and stop. Students must then swap roles and choose a different topic. Feed back how easy or difficult they found it to talk about one topic for a minute. If you think it will help, you should model an answer by speaking for a minute about a topic of your choice. If you are feeling brave, you could ask the class to select one for you.
- Explain the process of this part of the test:
 - The interlocutor shows the first candidate (Candidate A) two photographs.
 - They then ask Candidate A to do **two** things:
 - to compare the photographs **and**
 - to answer a question about them.
 - Candidate A speaks for a minute about the photographs.
 - After that, the other candidate (Candidate B) answers a short question (Listening Candidate Question LCQ) about one aspect of the photographs.
 - Candidates then reverse roles and repeat the same process, with different photographs, for Candidate B.
- Organise the students into pairs and allocate the roles so one student is the candidate and one is the interlocutor. Give out **Student's worksheets 1 and 2** to the 'interlocutor'. Allow a minute or two for the 'interlocutors' to read through the worksheets and ask you any questions.

6. Students then role-play Candidate A's turn in Part 2. Monitor and feed back comments on good aspects of any performances. Make a note of areas which students will need further work on for future classes. Point out that the follow-up LCQ question for Candidate B is included so the students can see what sort of question they may be asked. Ask the interlocutor to answer this question for 30 seconds in the role of the second candidate. If there's time, they can swap roles and repeat the whole procedure so both students have a chance to practice with these pictures.
7. Again, it may be a good idea for the teacher to model how to do this minute, especially if it is the first time the class are doing this. When you model make sure you refer to and answer the question.
8. Give out **Student's worksheet 3**. Based on what they've learned so far, ask students to work in pairs to decide if the statements are true or false.
9. Feed back with the whole class (see **Answer key**).
10. Now the students change roles. Give out **Student's worksheets 4 and 5** to the 'interlocutor'. Allow a minute or two for the 'interlocutors' to read through the worksheets and ask you any questions.
11. Students then role-play Candidate B's turn in Part 2. Monitor the pairs, and after this second role-play, ask the students how well they thought they performed. Give feedback, as appropriate. Again, you might want to model the answer. Again, if there's time, at the end they can swap roles and repeat the long turns and LCQ to make full use of the materials.

Suggested follow-up activities

- In future classes, play 'Just a Minute' from time to time using different topics.
- Give students plenty of practice in talking about photographs and other visuals, and expressing their ideas about them.
- Never be afraid to model the answers, it really helps the students for them to hear how it should be done.
- Do further practice role-plays of Part 2 activities.
- See the B2 First for Schools Speaking Advice for Teachers section on the Teaching English website. This contains useful general suggestions for preparing your students.

<http://www.cambridgeenglish.org/exams/first/>

Answer key

Student's worksheet 3

- 1 **False** Candidates should not speak during their partner's long turn.
- 2 **False** Candidates should start talking immediately in order to make the most use of their time. They shouldn't use the time that the interlocutor is speaking to prepare, as they will then miss the second part of the question. It's important not to leave long silences, nor to say 'that's all' – the interlocutor indicates when the candidate has spoken enough. Students need to practise comparing photographs as much as possible to improve their observation skills and increase their confidence.
- 3 **True** Candidates are asked to compare two different photographs. There is a thematic link between the visuals and this is explained to the candidates by the interlocutor. The important thing is that the candidate speaks clearly and coherently while sustaining a long turn.
- 4 **False** Although candidates have to compare the visuals, they shouldn't describe them in detail. Rather, the interlocutor asks them to give some kind of personal reaction to them. Candidates must listen carefully to what the interlocutor says, and make sure that they answer this part of the question. If they don't, they will probably find it hard to talk for a full minute. Teachers must make sure that their students are prepared for this and give plenty of varied classroom practice. If a candidate finds that they haven't heard or understood the instructions, they shouldn't be afraid to ask the interlocutor to repeat them. They aren't penalised for doing this as long as they ask before they start answering. **N.B.** The question appears above the visuals.
- 5 **False** The listening partner is asked a question about the speaking candidate's photographs after their partner's long turn. Partners are not asked to compare the same photographs.
- 6 **True** Because the test is timed, the examiner will stop candidates who talk for more than 1 minute. This is not a problem and shows the candidate that they have spoken enough. With timed practice, students will learn to time themselves well so that they can complete the task and fill a minute without needing to repeat themselves.
- 7 **True** After the speaking candidate has finished, the listening candidate is asked a question. Their answer should be 30 seconds or so. The listening candidate needs to listen carefully to what their partner is saying but must always remember not to interrupt during their partner's long turn.
- 8 **False** Candidates who finish early will be penalised, and they shouldn't feel that they need to rush. They need plenty of timed practice in this activity so that they get a feel for how long a minute lasts. If they don't practise, they may find that they run out of things to say before the minute is up. It's good to avoid this, as candidates need to make the most of the time to show their capabilities.

Student's worksheet 1

1 Free time

2 Museums

Part 2

4 minutes (6 minutes for groups of three)

Interlocutor In this part of the test, I'm going to give each of you two photographs. I'd like you to talk about your photographs on your own for about a minute, and also to answer a question about your partner's photographs.

*(Candidate A), it's your turn first. Here are your photographs. They show **people spending their free time in different ways.***

Give Candidate A Student's worksheet 2 (two photographs).

I'd like you to compare the photographs, and say **what are the advantages and disadvantages for the people of spending their free time in these different ways.**

All right?

Candidate A



1 minute

.....

Interlocutor

Thank you.

[Candidate B:] Which of these pictures do you think shows the best use of time? (Why?)

Candidate B



approximately
30 seconds

.....

Interlocutor

Thank you.]

Student's worksheet 2

What are the advantages and disadvantages for the people of spending their free time in these different ways?



Student's worksheet 3

Read these statements and decide if they are True or False.

In Part 2:

1. You talk to your partner for 1 minute.

T / F

2. You are given time to prepare what you are going to say.

T / F

3. Each candidate is given two different photographs.

T / F

4. You have to describe the visuals in detail and compare what you see.

T / F

5. Don't let your partner see your pictures.

T / F

6. It's okay if the interlocutor interrupts you.

T / F

7. You are asked to comment on your partners' visuals.

T / F

8. You should try and finish the task as quickly as possible.

T / F

Student's worksheet 4

	Now, (<i>Candidate B</i>), here are your photographs. They show people visiting different museums .
	<i>Give Candidate B Student's worksheet 5 (two photographs).</i>
	I'd like you to compare the photographs, and say what the people might find interesting about visiting these different museums .
	All right?
Candidate B 🕒 1 minute	
Interlocutor	Thank you.
	<i>[question for Candidate A]: which of these museums do you think would be most interesting for children? (Why?)</i>
Candidate A 🕒 approximately 30 seconds	
Interlocutor	Thank you.

Student's worksheet 2

What might the people find interesting about visiting these different museums?

